

Reading

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The Forest That Had Been Disappearing

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think had been happening to the forest?
- Guess: what are two reasons a rainforest might disappear?

For hundreds of years, a huge rainforest had been growing quietly in South America, home to millions of species of plants and animals. But in the last fifty years, large areas had been cut down for farming and wood before governments and scientists finally took real action.

By the early 2000s, companies had been cutting down trees so quickly that scientists warned an area the size of a small country was disappearing every year. Local communities, who had been living in the forest for generations, lost their homes and their traditional way of life.

Then environmental groups started a new project. They had been working with local farmers for two years when a new law banned illegal logging in the most important areas. Farmers received support to grow crops without destroying more trees.

Today, the deforestation rate in that region is much lower than it was twenty years ago. Scientists say that if people hadn't acted when they did, thousands more species would have lost their habitat forever.

The story of this rainforest shows that natural resources can recover — but only if people protect them before it is too late.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. A forest region that reduced its deforestation rate after action was taken
- b. A new law about farming machines
- c. A list of animal species in South America

2. Who lost their homes and traditional way of life?

- a. Scientists
- b. Local communities
- c. Environmental groups

3. What had companies been doing by the early 2000s?

- a. Planting new trees
- b. Cutting down trees very quickly
- c. Studying local animals

4. What did the new law do?

- a. It banned illegal logging in important areas
- b. It closed all farms in the region
- c. It stopped tourism in the forest

5. The deforestation rate today is higher than it was twenty years ago. — *True / False*

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — Lise Hazırlık — Reading · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

6. What does the text suggest about natural resources?

- a. They always disappear completely once damaged
- b. They can recover if people protect them in time
- c. They are not important for local communities

After you read

- What natural resources are important in your own country? Name two.
- Do you think laws are the best way to protect forests? Why or why not?

Saving the Sea Turtles

Before you read

- Look at the title and think: why might sea turtles be in danger?
- Guess: what could ordinary people do to help protect them?

Selin is a marine biology student who spends her summers on a small research project on the coast. Before she joined, volunteers had been counting sea turtle nests for three years, and the numbers were falling fast.

Sea turtles are an endangered species because of pollution, fishing nets, and the loss of safe beaches for laying eggs. If people hadn't started protecting the nesting beaches, many more turtles would have died before reaching the sea.

Every night in the summer, Selin and the other volunteers had been walking along the beach, looking for new nests. When they find one, they mark it and protect it from dogs, birds, and careless visitors.

The project also works with local hotels. If a hotel hadn't agreed to turn off its beach lights at night, the baby turtles would have walked towards the lights instead of the sea, because they naturally follow the brightest light.

Thanks to this teamwork, the number of nests on the beach has almost doubled in five years. Selin says the project shows that ordinary people can protect wildlife if they take action together.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. A student project that protects sea turtle nests on a beach
- b. A new law about fishing nets
- c. A holiday Selin took on the coast

2. Why are sea turtles an endangered species, according to the text?

- a. Because of pollution, fishing nets, and the loss of nesting beaches
- b. Because tourists like to watch them
- c. Because they migrate too far

3. What do the volunteers do at night in the summer?

- a. They walk along the beach looking for new nests
- b. They clean the hotel beach
- c. They study fish in the sea

4. Why do hotels turn off their beach lights at night?

- a. Because guests complain about the light
- b. Because baby turtles naturally follow the brightest light and could walk the wrong way
- c. Because it saves the hotel money

5. The number of turtle nests on the beach has gone down in the last five years. — *True / False*

6. What does the text suggest about protecting wildlife?

- a. Only scientists can protect endangered animals
- b. Ordinary people can protect wildlife if they work together
- c. Hotels are usually against conservation projects

After you read

- Have you ever seen or read about an endangered animal in your country? Which one?
- Write two sentences about what you would do to help protect an endangered species.